

practices. Some of these well accepted practices may be causing more harm than good, so you should carefully evaluate your choices before making one.

'It's too expensive'

Probably the most popular myth that deters people from going green is that 'Green is expensive'. This misconception arises out of a belief that in order to adopt a greener lifestyle, one needs to discard one's current one and buy newer, energy efficient products. Nothing could be farther than the truth. Going green does not entail refurbishing your house or getting a new car.



Even though CFLs may cost more, the energy savings in the long run make them a smart choice

Going green means adopting practices and habits that cut down on wastage of resources, like water, fuel or electricity. Instead of spending a small fortune on a Prius, try to adopt practices that cut down on fuel usage in your existing car. Drive at a higher gear, turn down the air conditioner (or avoid using it altogether) and get your car serviced regularly. Using fuel efficiently will actually lead to increased savings. Similarly, using the air conditioner at the right temperature can lead to significant savings in energy and money. Most organizations (including Tata Power) recommend setting the air conditioner to an optimum temperature of between 24C – 26C. For every degree that you lower the temperature by, you're consuming nearly 10% more power, but the change in cooling is barely perceptible. There are many, many more ways to cut down on energy usage in your home, and this handy list by Tata Power should get you started - <http://www.tatapower.com/sustainability/powersaving-tips.aspx>.

While using your existing appliances and devices efficiently can certainly go a long way, spending a little more upfront for increased savings in the long run is certainly a wise choice. CFLs cost more than conventional tube lights or incandescent bulbs (*shudder*) but think of the additional cost you'll be incurring every month on energy bills with a 60W bulb or a 40W tube. Spending a little more on energy